

2026 PBI SEOUL Conference

[Events Details] 2026.09.18.

date	time	Programs	Key Participants
Day 1 10.14. (Wed)	16:00	1st PBI Steering Committee Meeting	Steering Committee
	19:00	Welcome Reception	all
Day 2 10.15. (Thu)	09:00	Coffee break	
	09:30	Opening Ceremony (Live broadcast)	Remarks ▪ Park Jang-beom (KBS) ▪ Han Seong-suk ▪ David Jordan (PBI/BBC)
	10:10	Special Session The History and Current Landscape of PBI	▪ Inoue Tatsuhiko (NHK) ▪ David Jordan (PBI/BBC)
	10:30	Session 1: Preserving National Identity in a Global Media Environment	▪ Bay Fang (RFA) ▪ Marie-Philippe Bouchard (CBC) ▪ Rosa Romà i Monfà (3cat) ▪ Dennis Chen (PTS)
	12:00	Lunch	
	13:30	Session 2: Digital Platforms and the Future of Public Service Media ※Special Speech - Sunghan Kim (Head of Coupang Play)	▪ Paul Thompson (RNZ) ▪ Rhodri Talfan-Davies (BBC) ▪ Tham Loke Kheng (Mediacorp) ▪ Gaurav DWIVEDI (PB)
	15:00	Coffee break	
	15:30	Session 3: Public Service Media as a Cultural Institution ※Special Speech - You Hong-june (DG of National Museum of Korea)	▪ David Sutton (ABC) ▪ Robert Cristian Schwartz (ROR) ▪ Robert Šveb (HRT) ▪ Milen Mitev (BNR) ▪ Choi Sung-min (KBS)
	17:30	Special Session The Past, Present and Future of K-POP	PSY (Singer & Producer)
	18:30	Hotel → Official Dinner Venue	
	19:30	Official Dinner	KOREAN HOUSE

Day 3 10.16. (Fri)	07:30	CEOs' Breakfast	1. KBS (1) 2. PBI (1) 3.4. NHK (2) 5.6. FTV (2) 7.8. CBC (2) 9. SR (1) 10. 3Cat (1) 11. BNR (1) 12. HRT (1) 13. RFA (1) 14.15. RNZ (2) 16. Mediacorp (1) 17. PB (1) 18. RTM (1) 19. PTS (1) 20. BBC (1) 21. EBU (1) 22. PMA (1) 23.24. MNB (2)
	09:30	Session 4: Taking National Culture to Global Audiences	• Ryan Merkley (NPR) • Delphine Ernotte Cunci (FTV) • Lee Hwang-sun (KBS) • Cilla Benkö (SR) • Datuk Ashwad Ismail (RTM)
	11:00	Coffee break	
	11:30	Session 5: Public Service Media as Catalysts for Cultural Creativity (Focusing on Crisis Response and Sustainability) Closing Ceremony	• Kristian Porter (PMA) • Katherine Maher (NPR) • Noel Curran (EBU) • Claude Galipeau (CBC) • Karen Donders (VRT)
	13:00	Lunch	
	14:00	2nd PBI Steering Committee Meeting	Steering Committee
	15:00	Hotel → National Museum of Korea	
	16:00	Visit to the National Museum of Korea	Prospective Participants
	17:00	Special K-pop Concert Music Bank (Live broadcast)	*Advance reservation required

Topics and Speakers for Each Session

※ Only confirmed speakers and moderators are listed as of now.

☐ **Special Session**

- ▶ Topic: The History and Current Landscape of PBI
- ▶ Speakers:
 - Inoue Tatsuhiko (President of NHK, Japan)
 - David Jordan (Secretary General of PBI, UK)

☐ **Session 1: Preserving National Identity in a Global Media Environment**

▶ Main Topic

Global streaming services and digital platforms have transformed the way audiences consume content, creating unprecedented opportunities for cultural exchange while also raising concerns about cultural homogenization. Public service media play a critical role in protecting national languages, traditions, and values, while ensuring that younger generations remain connected to their cultural roots.

▶ Discussion Topics

- Protecting national languages and cultural diversity
- Strengthening cultural identity among younger audiences
- Supporting local and regional content production
- Preserving minority cultures and indigenous voices
- Balancing global influences with national values

▶ Speakers

- Bay Fang (President of RFA, USA) - Moderator
- Marie-Philippe Bouchard (President and CEO of CBC/Radio-Canada)
- Rosa Romà i Monfà (President of 3Cat, Catalonia, Spain)
- Dennis Chen (Vice President and CSO of PTS, Taiwan)

☐ **Session 2: Digital Platforms and the Future of Public Service Media**

▶ Main Topic

The rise of global OTT and AI-driven content discovery is fundamentally reshaping the media ecosystem. Public service media must rethink how they distribute content, engage audiences, and remain visible and relevant in a platform-dominated world while safeguarding editorial independence and public value.

► Discussion Topics

- The impact of global digital platforms on public service media
- Building and strengthening PSM-owned digital platforms
- Platform dependency versus strategic independence
- Artificial intelligence and audience engagement
- Reaching younger and digital-first audiences

► Speakers

- ※ Special Speech: Sunghan Kim (Head of Coupang Play)
- Paul Thompson (CEO of RNZ, New Zealand) - Moderator
- Rhodri Talfan-Davies (Deputy Director General of BBC, UK)
- Tham Loke Kheng (CEO of Mediacorp, Singapore)
- Gaurav DWIVEDI (CEO of PB, India)

□ **Session 3: Public Service Media as a Cultural Institution**

► Main Topic

Beyond broadcasting, public service media serve as guardians of collective memory and cultural heritage. Through archives, documentaries, historical dramas, educational programming, and partnerships with cultural institutions, PSM organisations play a vital role in preserving, interpreting, and passing on national stories and shared cultural experiences to future generations.

► Discussion Topics

- The role of broadcasting archives in preserving national memory
- Digitisation and long-term preservation of cultural heritage
- Collaboration with museums, libraries, and educational institutions
- Storytelling as a means of cultural preservation
- Public service media and historical responsibility

► Speakers

- ※ Special Speech: You Hong-june (DG of National Museum of Korea)
- David Sutton (Senior Executive of ABC, Australia)- Moderator
- Robert Cristian Schwartz (President Director General of ROR, Romania)
- Robert Šveb (Director General of HRT, Croatia)
- Milen Mitev (Director General of BNR, Bulgaria)
- Choi Sung-min (Executive Managing Director of KBS, Korea)

□ **Special Session: The Past, Present and Future of K-POP**

► **Main Topic**

Drawing on his firsthand experience of the global rise of K-pop through “Gangnam Style,” PSY will explore why K-pop has resonated with audiences around the world beyond linguistic and cultural barriers, and examine the role played by media—including YouTube, social media, and broadcasting—in its global expansion. He will also discuss the conditions needed for K-pop to evolve beyond a temporary trend into a sustainable global cultural phenomenon, as well as its future direction.

► **Speakers: PSY (Singer & Producer)**

□ **Session 4: Taking National Culture to Global Audiences**

► **Main Topic**

Public service media are increasingly acting as ambassadors of national culture. Through international co-productions, content distribution, cultural diplomacy, and strategic partnerships, they help share unique national stories with audiences around the world.

► **Discussion Topics**

- International co-productions and cultural exchange
- Exporting public service content to global markets
- Public service media as instruments of cultural diplomacy
- Enhancing national reputation through storytelling
- Strengthening cooperation among public broadcasters

► **Speakers**

- Ryan Merkley (COO of NPR, USA) - Moderator
- Delphine Ernotte Cunci (President of FTV, France)
- Lee Hwang-sun (Managing Director of KBS, Korea)
- Cilla Benkö (Director General of SR, Sweden)
- Datuk Ashwad Ismail (Director General of RTM, Malaysia)

□ **Session 5: Public Service Media as Catalysts for Cultural Creativity**

(Focusing on Crisis Response and Sustainability)

► **Main Topic**

Public service media do more than preserve culture—they help create it. By investing in original storytelling, nurturing creative talent, and embracing

innovation, public service media contribute significantly to vibrant national cultural ecosystems. However, their ability to fulfil this role depends on strong institutional foundations, including sustainable funding, editorial independence, public trust, and long-term policy support. This session will explore how public service media can continue to inspire cultural creativity while ensuring the institutional conditions necessary for their long-term sustainability and relevance.

► Discussion Topics

- Supporting emerging creators and creative industries
- Investing in original public service content and cultural initiatives
- Ensuring sustainable funding and long-term institutional support for public service media
- Aligning public funding mechanisms with technological innovation and rising operational demands
- Safeguarding editorial independence and strengthening public trust
- Building resilient and sustainable creative ecosystems through cross-sector collaboration

► Speakers

- Kristian Porter (CEO of PMA) - Moderator
- Katherine Maher (President and CEO of NPR, USA)
- Noel Curran (Director General of EBU)
- Claude Galipeau (Executive Vice President of CBC/Radio-Canada)
- Karen Donders (Public mission, talent & organisation, VRT, Belgium)